Greyling emerged as the outstanding candidate. Introduced to us by Martin van Jaarsveld, my old friend from Bela-Bela, she is a wonderful person whose kindness is only matched by her efficiency. In so many ways – big and small – over all these years, she has been fantastic.

The support team changed my life because they took responsibility for everything beyond the cricket, providing a stable, organised and professional source of common sense and proper advice. Where there had been pressure and uncertainty, they brought discipline and confidence, and I will always be extremely grateful.

As time passed, the chairman of the group became a source of regular support for me, even from his home in England or wherever he may have been in the world. We would communicate almost every day, usually by WhatsApp, but also by phone and email, discussing anything and everything that might be on my mind, and always agreeing on the best way forward.

His experience in elite sport meant he understood the pressures associated with being an international cricketer and equipped him to help me cope with, first, the stress created by the unrealistic expectation that I would score runs every time I bat and, second, the extraordinary amount of time I would have to spend away from home – international cricketers accept a travel schedule that even the best-paid and most energetic business people in the world would consider entirely unacceptable.

'REPS,' he told me one day. 'That's the key – REPS.'

He had created an acronym to help me recognise and overcome the challenges of my profession, an acronym to help me survive and thrive in a relentless environment of unrelenting pressure.

The *R* in REPS stands for '*Recognise* the thin line between success and failure'. As a batter, the line between being out for nought and scoring a century is very often as thin as a strand of hair. Some days you play and miss, survive and go on to make runs; other days you feather an edge and get out cheaply. That's the nature of the game, but problems arise when